

The Closing Paragraph – Conclusion.

Like what a conclusion does in most written communications, the closing paragraph brings into summary the message of the letter with many paragraphs. Moreover, the action(s) which the writer desires that the receiver should take after reading the letter is clearly re-inforced in the closing paragraph.

Most times, business and administrative letters are treated with much formality both in language and content. The reason is that the writer has as an uppermost goal the achievement of the action(s) to be initiated by the letter, as such he cannot afford to give any impression that would make the reader to take a repulsive stance.

Language Style in Letters

One glaring advantage which the oral communication has over the written one is the use of other non-conventional signals like facial expressions, the use of hands to gesticulate, the blinking of the eyes and others to help the oral expressions. These explain further the message of the speaker and so remove some ambiguities which would have existed in the language if it were to be written. In oral communication therefore, nods, smiles, postures, help to remove or reduce offences caused by inappropriate tone.

In comparison, the totality of the success in effectively conveying the message of the written communication like letter, depends essentially on the management of the language style adopted by the writer.

Another reason why language style should be given adequate attention is that the letter is a preservable document and can affect or influence so many situations in future. Therefore, all possible implications of the word choice in a letter must be weighed to avoid unnecessary commitments.

The appropriate advice in this situation is that the language style of a business letter should be cordial and inviting without begging. On the other hand, the language of a letter in the administrative circle should convey the appropriate orders without presenting personal interest. The writer must assume formal position and remove his personality and peculiarities from the focus of the letter. This upholds the principles of 'Sell Objectively', 'inform objectively'.

The Letter as an Ambassador

The function of the letter is to be an ambassador of the writer. The writer of the letter has some ideas which should be passed across and these are communicated through the letter. The writer will not be physically present when the reader would receive the message. He cannot therefore further

persuade him to accept some terms expressed in the letter. There is total dependence on the power of the letter to do the work of persuasion which the writer would have done should he be physically present. Therefore the letter acts in an ambassadorial capacity for the writer. Under this peculiar function the letter does the following:

1. Acts as a link between two parties involved in correspondence.
2. It speaks for the sender.
3. It holds the reputation of the writer.
4. The composition of the message determines the response the receiver would give.

In consideration of the above position of the letter the writer should adopt some careful measures to ensure good representation. The writer can achieve this by using words in their simple and short forms instead of long and high sounding words. It is also expedient to use formal language instead of 'sweet' unofficial language. In addition, excessive adjectivisation and adverbialisation should be avoided.

Planning a Letter

Writing a letter demands a little tactfulness. There is always the need to organise the idea(s) which one wants to express in a letter. A good idea may fail to yield result because its presentation makes it to lack all the sensibility which would have won approval for it. It is strongly advised that before one writes a letter, especially letters of business and official functions, a little planning should be done so as to achieve the desired effect.

To plan a letter effectively, the followings can be of help to the writer:

1. Consider briefly what constitutes the ideas or the substance of the letter.

By recognising the precise message of the letter, the writer would be able to put the scope of the letter into focus. He will know the exact situation which the letter would cover.

2. Identify the point from which to begin.

Is the letter a continuation of an old, existing correspondence or an initiation of a fresh one? There would be a difference in tone and point of beginning for one replying a letter as compared to a person who is initiating a fresh relationship.

3. Ideas conveyed in a letter should be arranged in a good order.

For example, it would be profitable for one to consider the reasons why

from the later.

Example of indented paragraph:

Paragraph I

Paragraph II

The Content of the Letter

Every effort made to communicate has an idea which forms the substance of the communication. What is referred to as the content of the letter implies two things:

1. It denotes the volume of writing outside the other formal features as have been discussed earlier.
2. It implies the real message which is encoded in the writing.

The message forms the substance of the content of the letter. The writing is a medium which is merely instrumental to the presentation of the real message.

However, the two are not separated. A contemplation of the two gives an understanding usually regarded as the content of the letter.

Aspects of the Content

The Paragraphs: The message in a letter is presented in units of idea development called paragraphs. In letters, paragraphs range from one to as many paragraphs as may seem desirable by the writer.

One paragraph letters: Some letters have one paragraph content. These are letters which have single messages. The stating of these messages do not require preambles or establishment of communication contexts and situations. Moreover, when the message of such letters is stated, there may not be any need for further elaboration.

For example: A letter from the General Manager of a Manufacturing Industry to the Director of Personnel of the same organisation may read thus:

"Your attention is drawn to a development of this organisation where staff members disobey rules by coming late to work. Please investigate the matter and device adequate measure to ensure that all staff abide by our rules to enhance efficiency."

There are only two sentences in this letter. It would be unrealistic to break

In multi-paragraph letters, there are three major categories of paragraphs:

1. The Opening Paragraph (Introduction)
2. The Middle Paragraph(s) (details of the message)
3. The Closing Paragraph (Conclusion)

The Opening Paragraph – Introduction

The opening paragraph puts the message of the letter to focus. It establishes the context of the communication. Ways of achieving this include:

Making reference to an already established situation needing further correspondence; and responding to a stimulus to establish a situation which warrants the communication procedures.

These are summed up in saying that the opening paragraph would acknowledge the receipt of earlier correspondence where one had existed before, quoting the appropriate date. It also may give further reasons for the writing of the letter. The elaborations on this indication of theme form the following paragraph(s).

The Middle Paragraph(s)

The number of paragraphs that make up the middle part of a letter (the body) depends on how extensive the message of the letter is. A letter with one subject-matter that is limited in scope may just have one or two middle paragraphs. The writer of the letter must achieve an aim in the middle paragraphs. There is the need that what constitute the substance of the letter must be stated here. In the most effectively concise manner the details of the message should be set down in the middle paragraph in logical but clear way.

In relating this, we note that, details of quantity, condition of goods, mode of payment at purchase and delivery of a particular good may be the pre-occupation of a reply to a letter of enquiry in the middle paragraph. In the same way, an explanation may be provided and action taken to correct anomaly stated in the middle paragraphs of a reply to a letter of complaint.

The details of the middle paragraph of a sales letter may remind a prospective customer of the sales offers of the producing company and further introduction of a range of new products, while an application may give details of qualifications and experiences relating to the job being applied for.

The number of the paragraphs required in this part of the letter depends on the simplicity or complexity of the message and how the writer is able to manage the arrangement of his ideas. It is advised that in letters with complex messages or extensive content, multi-paragraph system should be adopted to deal with aspects of the complex message. This ensures the

Information should come first or last in a letter. Is it proper to state a decision being conveyed first before stating the reasons that warranted the making of the decision or the other way round? This depends on the type of person that would receive the letter. In ordering the message of the letter therefore, recognition should be made of the person who would read the letter.

4. Put the message into the fewest possible words.
The fewer the words used the fewer the mistakes made. This does not imply abandoning the message so as to achieve conciseness.
5. At the level of planning, omit all the unnecessary facts and ideas in your letter.
6. Devise a method to create a good feeling in the person you are writing to.

Points to Note - Qualities of a good letter

For a good quality letter, there are some points which the writer must consider before and in the process of writing. The following points are useful in that consideration.

1. Keep the letter brief.
2. Be helpful - let your ideas or the message satisfy the information needs of your reader.
3. Be positive.
4. Be persuasive.
5. Be tactful but polite.
6. Avoid officialese - assuming too much air of official authority and importance.
7. Consider the recipient and apply cautions.
8. Avoid clichés - out-dated and redundant expressions.
9. Avoid over-familiarity.
10. Avoid irrelevances.
11. Check your letter before mailing.

The Letterhead

We had earlier discussed the format of the letter. We also discussed the systems of writing the address and other formal features of the letter. It would be an incomplete work to end without mentioning the 'letterhead'.

which when used takes care of most of the items that one would deal with separately if he is writing without letterhead.

The letterhead is the printed part of a letter sheet. It is pre-designed to supply some vital information about an organisation. The organisation uses the letterhead as an identity and therefore forwards its messages with it. The letterhead is designed to make space for where messages would be inserted in the sheet, whether typed or handwritten. All other information in the letterhead are printed.

It indicates the trading name, logo, address and other components that relate the image of the organisation. In the letterhead also the nature of business activities of a company is indicated.

General information obtainable in the letterhead include: name of the company, address - location, Post Office Box or Street number, telephone, telegraph or telex.

By law the letterhead should supply

- the trading name of the organisation.
- List of directors and address
- address of registered office
- Reference entries
- Registration number
- Location or country of registration, example, Nigeria, West Africa, London.

The need for all those information is to protect the receiver of such a letter from dubious activities. The information help for easy location and identification of the company in question.

Types of Letters and their General Uses.

It will not be possible to discuss all types of letters here because it is not even easy to enumerate all possible types of letters. There are letters that are only brought to existence by the particular need at the material time in which they were written. What we shall do here is to mention some types of letters and briefly say what they are used for.

1. Application - used for applying for a job and other posts or appointments.
2. Reference enquiry and Reference reply - used to seek confidential information and particulars and to provide confidential information

3. Circulars
 - used to reach the personnel or customers of an organisation in one despatch. They give information about things within a space of time.
4. Enquiries
 - used to seek information about something.
5. Letters of Acknowledgment
 - Used to acknowledge or to accept the receipt of something - information, message, goods, etc.
6. Letter of complaints and Adjustments
 - used to seek redress of a deficiency observed in either goods supplied or services rendered. The reply to a complaint letter is called adjustment letter. It gives advice to the complaining customer who seeks to rectify the complaint.
7. Sales letters
 - letters used to sell goods and services. Sales letters are also used to remind customers of sales offers.
8. Unsolicited Sales Letters
 - A letter of advertising. Used to introduce and describe the qualities of products so as to attract customers.
9. Orders
 - letters used to place orders that is, request for supply of a particular good. There are also confirmation that an order has been suited requesting the supply of the goods described.
10. Letter of Estimate
 - letter used in providing an estimated or projected price of a contract.
11. Tender
 - Letter used in submitting the actual price at which a particular contract would be carried out.
12. Letter of Credit
 - to authorise an advance of credit.
13. Letter of Financial Standing
 - letter that presents one's financial balance so as to inform on credit worthiness.

Letter layout

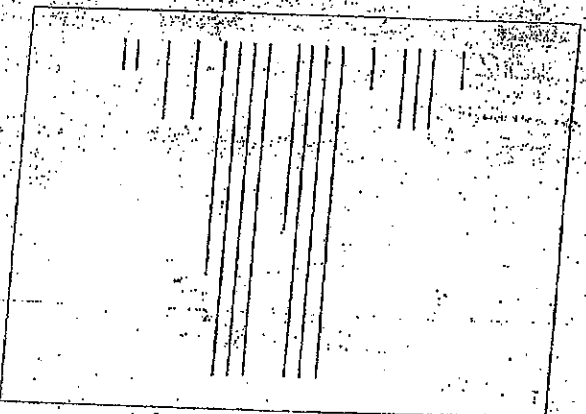
Just as much care is devoted to the letterhead design, so also is particular attention given to the overall appearance of the typescript. When it is set out beneath the letterhead. One business communication researcher ascribed as much as 25% of the business letter's total impact to its visual appearance. Thus both the graphics designer and the secretary, word processor operator or typist, have an extremely important combined role to play in the production of an elegant, crisp letter.

Many organisations have developed personalised ways of displaying their letters, and display conventions vary from one company to another — especially since, ultimately, there are no absolute rules governing letter layout, but rather sets of generally accepted conventions which most letter-writers agree to accept. Thus the elements of letter layout are constantly subject to change, as one practice is superseded by another in order to achieve greater simplicity, speed of production or pleasing appearance.

The following models indicate in outline the principal shapes of currently popular typescript letter layouts, which are used in conjunction with whatever letterhead design a company or institution has chosen to adopt.

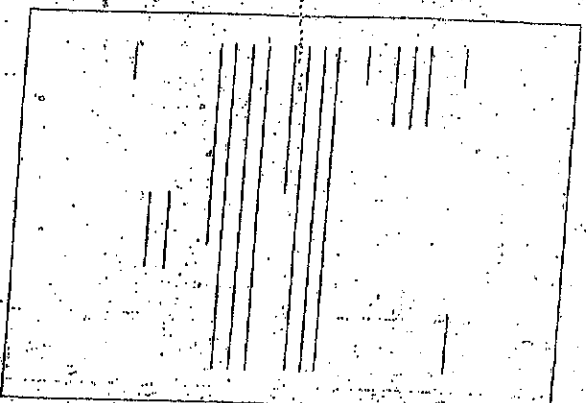
Fully-blocked

All the typed entries commence from the left-hand margin, forming a 'vertical line' down the page.



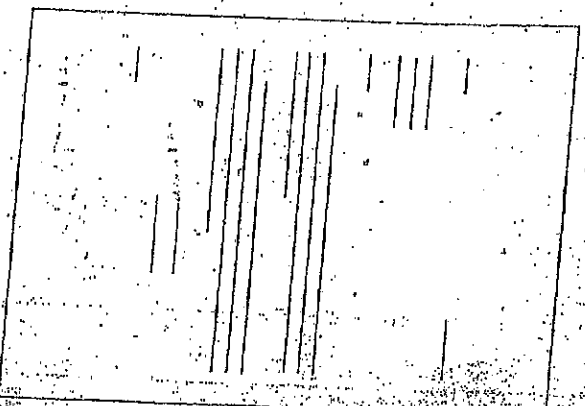
Blocked

The date is displayed near the right-hand margin and the complimentary close to the right of a central position. Otherwise as for 'fully-blocked'.



Semi-blocked

The date and complimentary close are situated to the right of centre and each paragraph is indented.



[← Back to All Citation Guides](#)

APA (American Psychological Association) style is most frequently used within the social sciences, in order to cite various sources. This APA Citation Guide, revised according to the 6th edition of the APA manual, provides the general format for in-text citations and the reference page. For more information, please consult the Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association, (6th ed.).

Select from one of the source types below to start creating the perfect citation in APA format. We also have a powerful automatic APA citation generator. To begin just check out our APA citation generator.

APA Book Citation

[← Back to APA Citation Guide](#)

How to Cite a Book in APA

Use the following template to cite a book using the APA citation format. We also provide style guides for the MLA, Chicago, and Turabian styles. To have your bibliography or works cited list automatically made for you, check out our free APA citation generator.

Once you're finished with your citations, we can also help you with creating an APA title page.

Citing a book in print

APA format structure:

Author, A.A. (Year of Publication). Title of work. Publisher City, State, Publisher.

APA format example:

Finney, J. (1970). Time and again. New York, NY: Simon and Schuster.

Notes: When citing a book in APA, keep in mind:

- Capitalize the first letter of the first word of the title and any subtitles, as well as the first letter of any proper nouns.
- The full title of the book, including any subtitles, should be stated and italicized.

Citing an e-book from an e-reader

E-book is short for "electronic book." It is a digital version of a book that can be read on a computer, e-reader (Kindle, Nook, etc.), or other electronic device.

APA format structure:

Author, A.A.. (Year of Publication). Title of work [E-Reader Version]. Retrieved from <http://xxxx> or doi:xxxx

APA format example:

Eggers, D. (2008). The circle [Kindle Version]. Retrieved from <http://www.amazon.com/>

Citing a book found in a database

APA format structure:

Author, A.A.. (Year of Publication). Title of work. Retrieved from <http://xxxx> or doi:xxxx

APA format example:

Sayre, Rebecca K., Devercelli, A.E., Neuman, M.J., & Wodon, Q. (2015). Investment in early childhood development: Review of the world bank's recent experience. doi: 10.1596/978-1-4648-0403-8

Notes: When citing an online book or e-book in APA, keep in mind:

- A DOI (digital object identifier) is an assigned number that helps link content to it's location on the Internet. It is therefore important, if one is provided, to use it when creating a citation. All DOI numbers begin with a 10 and are separated by a slash.

For more information on how to cite in APA, check out Purdue OWL and Cornell.

←Back to APA Citation Guide

The MLA system uses in-text citations rather than footnotes or endnotes. The citations in-text are very brief, usually just the author's family name and a relevant page number. These citations correspond to the full references in the list of works cited at the end of the document.

Instructions and examples in this MLA guide are based on more detailed information in:

Gibaldi, Joseph. MLA handbook for writers of research papers. 7th ed. New York : Modern Language Association of America, 2009.

In-text citations - general points

- If the author's name is mentioned in the sentence, only cite the page number.
- If the author's name is not mentioned in the sentence, cite both the name and the page number.
- Font and capitalisation must match that in the reference list.
- Long quotations (more than three lines) should be indented.
- If you are citing more than one reference at the same point in a document, separate the references with a semicolon eg (Smith 150; Jackson 41).
- If the work has no author, use the title.
- If you are citing two works by the same author, put a comma after the author's name and add title words. eg (Smyth, "Memories of Motherhood" 77) to distinguish between them in the in-text citation. Do this when citing each of the sources throughout the piece of writing.
- If two authors have the same surname, use their first initial eg (G. Brown 26)

Works Cited list - general points

- The recommended heading for the reference list is Works Cited, which should be centred.
- Each reference should be formatted with double-spacing and a hanging indent.
- Capitalise the first word of the title or subtitle, and all other significant words.
- Author's names should be listed with full forenames if known.
- The name of the first author is inverted to list the family name first. If there are additional authors their names are not inverted.
- If you cite more than one work by the same author, give the names in the first entry only. Thereafter, use three hyphens instead of the name, eg ---.
- If a reference does not have an author, list it by title. Ignore the leading article (A, The etc.) when inserting the reference into the alphabetical works cited list.
- If you cannot validate a reference's authorship, date of publication or its authoritativeness, especially if it is an online resource, consider using another similar reference that is more authoritative instead.

Gibaldi, Joseph. *MLA handbook for writers of research papers. 7th ed.* New York : Modern Language Association of America, 2009.

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- The name of the first author is inverted to list the family name first. If there are additional authors their names are not inverted.
- If you cite more than one work by the same author, give the names in the first entry only. Thereafter, use three hyphens instead of the name; eg ---.
- If a reference does not have an author, list it by title. Ignore the leading article (A, The etc.) when inserting the reference into the alphabetical works cited list.
- If you cannot validate a reference's authorship, date of publication or its authoritativeness, especially if it is an online resource, consider using another similar reference that is more authoritative instead.

For a journal article in an online database (e.g. via the Library website) include the name of the database (italicized), the medium of publication (Web) and the date of access.

How to create a hanging indent

Watch this video to learn how to create a hanging indent when you are compiling your Works Cited list in MLA format. These instructions are for MS Word 2010.

Why is Referencing Important?

Referencing or citing your sources is an important part of academic writing. It lets you acknowledge the ideas or words of others if you use them in your work and helps avoid plagiarism.

When books, journals, official publications, newspapers etc. are used to reinforce ideas in an essay, you must give credit to these sources.

Referencing also demonstrates that you've read relevant background literature and you can provide authority for statements you make in your assignments.

Very scholarly discipline has a preferred format or style for citing sources. A widely accepted method used in the humanities is the MLA documentation style. The following guide explains how to use this system, however, if you require further information consult the MLA handbook for writers of research papers.

Please remember to check with your unit co-ordinator or tutor before submitting your assignments, as their style preference may vary from the guidelines presented here.

Referencing Started

There are two components to referencing: in-text citations in your paper and the reference list at the end of your paper.

In-text citation:

- Are brief and only provide as much information as is necessary to identify the source as it appears in the Reference List/Bibliography. This generally means the author's name and the page reference.

-text citation of a book (the same format applies for a journal article)

the author's name is mentioned in the text, only the page number appears in the citation.

7.0 PRINCIPLES OF LETTER WRITING

Business correspondence and official letters are written in various circumstances. They include application letters, letters of appointment, appreciation letters, query, complaints, congratulatory letters, inquiry, order, condolence, invitation etc.

COMPONENTS OF A BUSINESS LETTER

1. Writers address: This is usually written at the top right hand corner of the page. It may

be written in block form or indented form. It may also open or closed punctuation depending on preference. An address has open punctuation when there are no punctuation marks at the end of each line of the address and it has closed punctuation if there are punctuation marks at the end of each line of the address. e.g.

(a) Block form

Open punctuation
Yuhur Ventures Plc
P.M.B. 1045,
Makurdi
Benue State

ii. Closed punctuation
Yuhur Ventures Plc,
P.M.B. 1045,
Makurdi,
Benue State.

(b) Indented form

i. Open punctuation

Yuhur Ventures Plc
P.M.B. 1045
Makurdi
Benue State

ii. Closed punctuation

Yuhur Ventures Plc,
P.M.B. 1045,
Makurdi,
Benue State.

2. Date: This usually comes immediately below the writers address. It should follow the format day, month and year. For business letters, short forms are not allowed e.g.
15th August, 2011.
15th August 2011

3. **Inside name and address:** this is the designation and address of one's correspondent. It is usually written on the left hand corner of the page after the date. It should follow the same form with the writers address i.e if the writers address is in block form, the inside address should also be in block form and vice versa. Similarly, if the writers address has open punctuation, the inside address will also have open punctuation and vice versa. e.g

The manager,
Phil-Ndal Enterprises Plc,
P.O.Box 553,
Maiduguri.

Phil-Ndal Enterprises Plc
P.O.Box 553
Maiduguri

Phil-Ndal Enterprises Plc,
P.O.Box 553,
Maiduguri.

Phil-Ndal Enterprises Plc
P.O.Box 553
Maiduguri

4. **Salutation:** this is the normal opening greeting in a business letter. It comes one line space below the inside address e.g.

Dear Sir

Dear Madam

For individual

Dear Sirs

Dear Madams

For partnership

Dear Mr Andu

Dear Mrs Andu

For long standing customers

5. **Subject heading or title:** This gives concisely the subject matter on which one is writing e.g a letter of complaint, application for the post of manager etc. Thus should be written in bold print.

6. **Body of the letter:** This should be written in paragraphs. The introductory part should clearly specify the purpose of writing e.g I wish to apply for the post of manager in your company as advertised in the 'Daily Trust' of 15th August, 2011. There is need to avoid the use of contracted forms, slangs, colloquialisms and Americanisms in business correspondence.

7. **Complementary close:** This is the closing greeting in business letter. The complementary close should always be in harmony with the salutation. E.g

Dear Sir
Dear Madam

Yours faithfully

Dear Mr Andu
Dear Mrs Andu

Yours Sincerely

8. **Writer's name:** This should be written in full. Female should indicate marital status e.g. Musa Jauro Adamu
Mainmuna Andu (Mrs)

9. **Writer's signature:** This is the signed name or mark of the writer. Signatures are of two types – facsimile signature and signature by proxy.
Facsimile signature is where the writer signs by himself while
Signature by proxy is where one signs for another person.

10. **Designation of writer:** This may be required in some letters but not in others. Here the writer indicates his rank e.g Manager, Accountant etc.

8.0 MEMORANDUM: This is also a form of correspondence which is used within an organization. It is usually written on printed forms specifically designed for that purpose. The have the following information printed on the them.

- i. The name of the organization e.g THE FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC MUBI
- ii. Date
- iii. Reference No
- iv. To
- v. From
- vi. Subject
- vii. cc

e.g

THE FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC MUBI

MEMORANDUM

REF No. DGS/PPM/15/2

To: All Heads of Department

Date: 15th August 2011

From: H.O.D General Studies

cc

Subject: Submission of list of service courses.

I write to request all departments requiring the services of service lecturers from the Department of General Studies to please send the list of such courses to reach our Departmental Examination Officer (D.E.O) not later than 20th August, 2011.

This is to enable us prepare our course allocation to reach the deadline given by the central time-table committee please.

A. A. Banga

Almadu A. Banga,

(for H.O.D)

PROJECT REPORT

This refers to a report that is submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the award of a diploma, higher diploma, degree or higher degree

TOPIC SELECTION FOR A PROJECT REPORT

There are two ways of selecting a topic for a project report-supervisor selected and candidate selected

1. **Supervisor Selected:** This is where the supervisor selects the topic without consulting the candidate.

Advantages:

- (a) The topic will be appropriate and publishable.
- (b) The interest of the supervisor in the topic will guarantee careful supervision

Disadvantages:

- (a) It is exploitative and unfair to the candidate.
- (b) The topic could be boring to the candidate since his interest is not considered.

- (c) It might be very difficult to satisfy the supervisor since he is very versed in the topic he is likely to choose.
- ii. Candidate selected: This is where the candidate selects the topic of the project by himself.

Advantages:

- (a) The candidate must be interested in the topic before he selects it.
- (b) Candidate will put in his best to satisfy his interest.

Disadvantages:

- (a) The topic selected may be too bored and the candidate cannot focus.
- (b) The topic might not be appropriate to the candidate's level of study.
- (c) The topic may take a lot of time to accomplish.
- (d) The topic may not be feasible due to reasons of logistics, techniques, etc

FORMAT OF A PROJECT

- I. **Title page:** This contains the same information as the cover of the project. It states the title of the project, by whom submitted, submitted to whom, forward and when e.g. The courses of failure in science subject by students in Adamawa state: A case study of Hong I. G. A being a dissertation submitted to the Department of Education, University of Maiduguri in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of Bachelor of Science (BSC) degree October 2010.
 - II. **Table of Contents:** This gives the topics and the pages where they are found. It helps the reader to turn at once to those parts of the report that interests him. It is usually arranged in chronological order.
 - III. **Certification Page:** This is a statement certifying that the study was carried out by the student under the supervision of the supervisor e.g. This is to certify that the research work of this project was carried out by (name of student) under our supervision. This is endorsing by the candidate, the supervisor and the Head of Department.
 - IV. **Acknowledgement:** This is where the researcher expresses gratitude for the contribution of others towards the success of the research work/ project. All sources used in the study should be acknowledged.
 - V. **Dedication:** The researcher may dedicate his study to an individual.
 - VI. **Abstract:** this is a summary of evidence and recommendations it makes it easier for the reader to follow the detailed report. It normally provides background to the report, report methodology and gives a summary of the findings and their implication.
- CHAPTER 1:**

1.0. INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 **Background to the study:** This area provides information on known facts about the study area and introduces new area that requires further investigation.
- 1.2 **Statement of the problem:** Here the researcher states the problem and indicates the need for solution to the problems. He cites the extent of studies carried out and what needs to be done.

- 1.3 **Objectives of the study:** This gives the purpose of the study or research. It must take a simple and concise terms what the study is out to achieve.
- 1.4 **Significance of the study:** This area explains the value of the research to knowledge. To state the benefit of the study to mankind, society etc.
- 1.5 **Research hypothesis:** this refers to the statement assuming relationship between variables which will tested by the study before acceptance or rejection.
- 1.6 **Limitation of the study:** This is where the researcher gives the areas to be covered by the report and their limitations. It shows the extent to which the researcher intends to achieves its objectives and the difficulties that might affect this. e.g time, finance, research instruments etc.
- 1.7 **Definition of terms:** Here the researcher explains terms that might be unfamiliar or technical to the reader and which are therefore liable for misinterpretation.

CHAPTER 2:

2.0 Literature review:

This give a theoretical frame work of the research work and reveals the current state of affairs and the particular area of study. There is need to look for information from libraries, internets etc. library sources may include books, journal, articles etc. they may also include unpublished research report e.g students projects, thesis etc. also included are seminar papers, learned conferences, gazettes by government, constitution, decrees, statutes etc.

CHAPTER 3

3.0 RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Study Area: This refers to the area to be covered by the research and how this will affect the choice of sampling technique.

3.2 **Study population:** This refers to the overall population that will be needed for the study e.g. a study on the courses of failure of students in science subjects in Adamawa state will require the study of variables in all the secondary schools in Adamawa state.

3.3 **Sampling techniques:** This is where the researcher gives the methods he will use for selection of samples. Since he cannot cover the whole study population the reason for the choice of the sampling method should also be stated in order to eliminate bias.

3.4 **Method of data collection:** Here is given the methods the researcher will use for the collection of data. This may include both primary and secondary sources.

Primary sources refers to information that is got first i.e not through other sources e.g through questionnaires, interviews, personal witnesses, material evidences etc.

Secondary sources refers to a source within a source e.g through books, previous reports, journals, research papers etc. all precautions taken in the administration of the tools also needed to be stated.

3.5 **Analysis of Data:** The method to be used for analysis of data should clearly explained. This is because it is changing raw data to coded data for further analysis.

CHAPTER FOUR

4.0 Research Result/Discussion

In this section, the outcome of the findings is explained. Data which are quantitative should be illustrated by means of diagrams, tables, figures etc. The researcher gives interpretation to the data generated in respect to the research question/hypotheses eg. How do the results differ from or conform to previous studies? How do your research findings contribute to knowledge? Etc.

CHAPTER FIVE

5.0 Summary/Recommendations

5.1 **Summary:** This provides a synopsis of the research findings. These should be itemized properly for easy reference.

5.2 **Conclusions:** these are made based on the results derived from the tools administered during investigation. It is on the basis of conclusions drawn that recommendations are made.

5.3 **Recommendations:** These are suggestions that given in form of solutions to the problems that necessitated the investigation. It could also give new areas for further research on the study area.

REFERENCES/BIBLIOGRAPHY

This is where the researcher arranges the works of others consulted during the research by way of acknowledgement. This should be based on the style of referencing chosen eg. APA, MLA etc. The works cited should be arranged in alphabetical order.

METHODS OF GATHERING DATA FOR A PROJECT REPORT

1. **QUESTIONNAIRE:** This is a set of questions that are posed in order to obtain responses in relation to variables identified in the objectives of the study. Questionnaires are good for obtaining empirical data.

TYPES

- a. **Open or Unstructured:** These pose questions but do not restrict the respondents to any of the responses ie. The respondent is free to provide any response in his desired manner.
- b. **Close or Structured:** These pose questions and also provide a set of answer or responses from which the respondent select. "Other" is usually provided at the end of the list of options to take care of responses not included in the list.

2. **INTERVIEWS:** This refers to one to one interaction between the researcher and the respondent. The researcher prepares his questions and these are presented in logical order in a venue that is free from interruptions. He also decides the method of recording information eg. By tape recorders note - taking or a combination of both.

3. **FIELD FORMS:** These are researcher administered information collation device which are similar to the questionnaire except in their layout. They are useful in descriptive and experimental studies and are less costly and simpler to use than the questionnaire. eg.

Child Number	Age	Sex	Weight	Height
1	10	M	25 kg	0.85 m
2	7	F	20 kg	0.75 m
3	15	M	30 kg	1.0 m

4. **ATTITUDINAL SCALE:** These are also similar to the questionnaire but they are capable of collecting information on extent, degree, level and scale of an action or attitude which otherwise cannot be quantified. They are used to measure variables that are non - empirical as they convert them to empirical variables eg.

Always 2 Sometimes 1 Never 0

- i. I like swimming _____
- ii. I came to school late _____
- iii. I have headache _____

5. **OBSERVATION:** This tool is used for collecting information about an object process. Observation is used when the description of a situation, event or process is required. It can also be used for evaluating a training or instructional process.

TYPES

- a. **Structured observation:** Here the variable to be observed is recorded on a form and the researcher is well informed about the subject.
- b. **Participant observation:** This is where the researcher is part of the group throughout the time of the observation. It involves coming to link with those to be observed eg. By taking up membership of the group for instance a social club to study its mode of operation.

6. **FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION:** This is a technique of data collection from a small carefully selected group (6-8 individuals) representing a large group in order to discuss an item of interest in a free and uninhibited manner through the guide of a facilitator. The topic must be of mutual interest to both the group and the researcher.

MUSA

Automobile Mechanical Engineering

Mubi North Adamawa State

Phone Number
08038211756
0810334109

The SLUES Coordinator,
Federal Polytechnic Mubi,
20 July, 2023

ACCEPTANCE LETTER

With reference to your letter Ref. NO FPM/SLUES/PLC/04/1/xx dated: 6th October, 2023, I am directed to write and inform you that your student RAYMONA YAHAYA with Reg number ET/mg/na/22/029 has been accepted by MUSA Automobile Mechanical Engineering for the SLUES Training programme. Thanking you that Mubi, Opposite mubi sub station Adamawa State

You are therefore wish to release the above named student for the programme at the appropriate time.